

Customer Professionalism -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit 5.1 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. Core 2 4.1 | N10-008

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

Active listening means giving the customer your full _____ and not interrupting them. After they finish speaking, a technician should _____ back what they said to confirm understanding (e.g., 'So what I'm hearing is...'). This technique is called _____ and reduces misunderstandings and repeat calls.

Answer: Attention; repeat (paraphrase); reflective listening (paraphrasing / active feedback).

Question 2

Open-ended questions cannot be answered with yes or no and _____ more information from the customer (e.g., 'Can you describe what happens when you turn it on?'). Closed questions _____ the answer to yes or no (e.g., 'Does it turn on?'). Open-ended questions should be used primarily at the _____ of the troubleshooting conversation.

Answer: Gather (elicit); limit; beginning.

Question 3

Before beginning any repair, a professional technician should set _____ by communicating the estimated _____ of the repair and its likely _____ to the customer. If unexpected complications arise during the repair, the technician should _____ the customer before proceeding rather than surprising them later.

Answer: Expectations; timeline (duration); cost (price); notify (contact).

Question 4

When explaining a technical issue to a non-technical customer, a good technician avoids _____ (technical language and acronyms the customer does not understand) and uses _____ instead. For example, instead of saying 'the HDD is experiencing read/write head actuator failure,' say '_____'.

Answer: Jargon; plain language (analogies); something like: 'the part that reads your files is broken and we need to replace the drive.'

Question 5

When repairing a customer's device, a technician must respect the customer's _____ by only accessing files, folders, and data that are _____ to the repair. Accessing personal photos, documents, or accounts that are not related to the technical problem is _____ and could violate _____ laws.

Answer: Privacy; necessary (relevant); unethical (unprofessional); privacy.

Question 6

Escalation is the process of transferring a problem to a _____ -level technician or specialist when the issue is beyond the current technician's _____ or _____. Before escalating, the technician should

document what has been _____ and share that information with the next technician to avoid repeating steps.

Answer: Higher; skill level; authority; tested (tried).

Question 7

After completing a repair, the technician should document all _____ performed, all _____ replaced or installed, and the _____ to the problem. Following up with the customer after service -- for example, calling the next day to confirm everything is working -- builds _____ and reduces call-backs.

Answer: Work (steps); parts (components); solution (root cause and fix); trust (customer satisfaction).

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: You arrive to repair a business client's computer. The client is agitated and says, 'This is the third time this has happened -- your company always does a bad job.' You believe the recurring issue is caused by something the client is doing. Describe how you would handle this situation professionally, using the communication techniques from this unit.

Answer: Step 1 -- Remain calm. Do not become defensive or argue. Let the client express their frustration without interruption. Step 2 -- Use active listening and reflective listening: 'I hear that this has been very frustrating, and I want to make sure we resolve it correctly this time.' Step 3 -- Ask open-ended questions to understand the full history: 'Can you walk me through what happens each time this occurs? Is there a pattern in when it starts?' Step 4 -- Avoid blame or defensiveness about previous visits -- document what you find. Step 5 -- Set clear expectations: 'I will diagnose the root cause today and explain exactly what is causing the recurring issue before I leave.' Step 6 -- If the client is causing the issue, explain it plainly without jargon: 'It looks like the issue may be connected to how the software updates are being handled -- I can show you a quick step that will prevent this.' Step 7 -- Follow up the next day to confirm resolution.